

Setting up your Modem

If you are using an external modem, there is a good chance that it will be installed on its own without asking for any drivers. But if you are using an internal modem, follow these simple steps to set it up:

1 In the Mandrake Control Center, click on the 'Network and Internet' tab. If there is only a modem connected to the machine, go ahead with the default profile, else create a new profile and name it appropriately. The next window will have three options: 'Choose profile to configure', 'Auto detect' and 'Expert mode'.

2 Use 'Auto detect' as it will detect the modem automatically and display the

information regarding where it is connected. Click 'Next'.

3 The 'Control Center' will present you with the configuration window. Click 'OK' to feed in the required information.

4 In the 'Dial-up' option box, give the phone number you use to connect to your ISP and your login name and password.

5 Mandrake will bring you back to the first screen, from which you can test the modem connection. The Control Center will display information such as the data sent and received, and will show the status of the modem (whether it's connected or not).

file systems and more from any computer with a secure browser connection. Automated software management systems URPMI (and APT) provide a hassle-free way to install and upgrade applications and Auto-Install tools duplicate servers and workstations effortlessly.

Conclusion

There is little doubt that Mandrake 8.2 is the easiest Linux distribution to install and has a very friendly desktop interface. There were absolutely no compatibility issues. From GeForce2 Ultra 64 MB cards to printers, scanners, serial modems and USB

Mandrake 8.2

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Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of Use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for Money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Freeware, \$69 (approx Rs 3,450) for a retail box with manual

Contact: www.mandrake.com

mice, everything was detected without any trouble. It displayed rock solid stability except for the odd sluggish response. We were constantly struck by a feeling of déjà vu while browsing through the Control Center, which is probably the best thing that happened to Linux, making it simple to set up and configure your system. Mandrake has done a lot of work in cleaning up the user interface and making Linux much more intuitive and user friendly. All in all, Mandrake 8.2 is the best Mandrake release ever. If you want a free office suite with a super stable operating system and fully featured server tools, then there is little that you can argue about. This latest release makes Mandrake a definite candidate for the top spot in the hard fought war for the desktop Linux distribution of choice. 

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